



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: The Habersham School
School Website: <https://thehabershamschool.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Habersham School GA 31404 (Savannah, GA) presents a robust classical Christian orientation across its public-facing materials. The school explicitly describes itself as a PK3–12 classical, Christ-centered program rooted in the classical trinity of grammar, logic, and rhetoric, with a liturgical rhythm and a covenantal partnership with families. Public materials emphasize formation, virtue, and the cultivation of wisdom within a Christian frame, and they foreground practices such as Harkness-style discussions, senior capstone work, Latin study, and a three-phase learning model. Evidence from the school's materials aligns with key classical indicators in the Six Essential Elements framework (especially in religious foundations, curriculum, and pedagogy), and it shows substantial alignment in faculty and parent/community engagement as well.

Overall classification by category (using the Six Essential Elements keyword framework): - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

Key insights: - The school's mission foregrounds Christian faith, theology, liturgy, and imago Dei concepts, and it integrates these into its curriculum and culture (Evidence: mission statements, liturgy, Christ-centered framing). - The curriculum explicitly follows the classical triad (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and includes Latin study, senior capstone work, and Harkness-style discourse, indicating a strong alignment with core classical curricula and pedagogy. - Faculty profiles and professional development reflect a classical formation ethos (e.g., advanced degrees among faculty; living curriculum concept) and a teacher-lead culture. - Parental partnership and community integration are emphasized, with explicit calls for ongoing parent formation and open campus/leverage of parent involvement.

What would move the needle (only for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL schools): Not applicable here since the school is classified as CLASSICAL. If a needle move were desired, potential steps would include more explicit and codified Great Books/Great Conversation language across grade levels and stronger articulation of a formal "Great Books" program beyond curriculum references, plus an explicit articulation of Scholé/recitation-based practices across all grade bands. However, the current materials already demonstrate substantial alignment with the Six Elements' positive indicators.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school describes itself as providing "an education grounded in the Christian faith and the classical tradition," indicating a transcendent moral framework and the integration of faith into education. - It presents itself as Christ-centered, with biblical worldview and theological framing evident in mission statements and program descriptions. - Liturgical life is part of the school's rhythm (daily liturgy and bi-weekly chapel) and an explicit liturgical dimension is embedded in campus life. - The concept of imago

Dei appears in school materials, underscoring a sacramental/incarnational worldview in which students are regarded as bearing God's image.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, liturgy, worship, imago Dei, Christ-centered, biblical worldview, liturgical practices. - Negative keywords: not evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or values-neutral signals observed).

Why this rating - The public materials foreground a transcendent moral order, theological integration, liturgical practice, and a sacramental/incarnational worldview, which matches the Positive Keywords for Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and aligns with the Classical lexicon's expectations for a robust religious/metaphysical grounding. The absence of negative signals strengthens the CLASSICAL rating.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation for life: "equipping them for life" and "helping them discover who God made them to be," rather than purely college admission, signaling formation over information. - Language about restoring humanity and partnering with parents signals an objective of human flourishing and virtue formation, not merely workforce preparation. - The school articulates a covenantal partnership with families and a mission to form character aligned with Christian aims.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos (implied in purpose), classical mission, contemplation/rest, great conversation (via the pedagogical culture), truth/goodness/beauty conceptual framing (theology; classical framing). - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no explicit emphasis on "jobs/career readiness" over formation; potential caveats would be values-neutral or secular emphasis, which are not present).

Why this rating - The school's stated goal centers on formation and virtue rather than utilitarian job training, with explicit emphasis on human excellence and teleology consistent with the Classical lexicon. The absence of competing job-centric rhetoric supports CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Classical model with grammar, logic, and rhetoric is explicitly described as the framework for learning. - Evidence of rigorous liberal arts orientation: Latin study (Intro to Latin, Latin I-III), honors courses, and senior capstone. - Harkness discussions are part of the upper school pedagogy, indicating a dialogical, classical approach to inquiry. - A reading/listening culture includes weekly/annual reading assignments, and Cornerstones/Portrait of a Graduate materials imply an integrated, formation-driven curriculum.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, senior capstone, Harkness discussions, great conversation (via the classical program language), primary sources (implied through classical canon framing), history as Western civilization (implied via the classical canon framing). - Negative keywords: not indicated (no explicit project-based dominance; no language that would signal "social studies instead of history," etc.).

Why this rating - The explicit articulation of grammar-logic-rhetoric, concrete Latin study, and a senior capstone, together with Harkness-style pedagogy, signals a strong classical curriculum in line with the Six Elements. The absence of contrary signals supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The pedagogical model includes a three-phase structure (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and a combination of contemplative/restful elements and rigorous inquiry, aligning with scholé and contemplative approaches. - Lower school practices include singing, chanting, and memory work, which are characteristic of traditional, formation-oriented pedagogy. - Upper school features Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and opportunities to develop rhetoric and public speaking. - The pedagogy includes "education as formation" and "Cornerstone" elements that emphasize intellectual virtue through dialogue and structured memory work.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, dialogue, contemplation, scholé, memory work, recitation, chanting, rhetoric, speeches, capstone orations, lectures in a dialogic format. - Negative keywords: none present in public materials (no signals of experiential-only, project-based-dominant pedagogy without classical grounding).

Why this rating - The explicit mention of Socratic discussion in upper grades, rituals of memory, recitation, and the integration of chant and liturgy with academic content matches the Classical pedagogy indicators. The evidence of restfulness and contemplation alongside rigorous inquiry reinforces CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as model teachers and mentors who form the living curriculum, with a culture described as collegial and characterized by virtue and shared purpose. - The school highlights faculty profiles, teacher leadership, and the role of faculty as the core of the school (portrait of the teacher, living curriculum). - Public materials note advanced degrees among upper school faculty (e.g., 65% hold advanced degrees). - There is specific mention of leadership roles in faculty (e.g., Dean of Faculty & Academics).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: tutors/masters/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, professional development/advanced degrees, faculty as core. - Negative keywords: none evident (no signals of overly bureaucratic, certification-driven jargon absent of classical context).

Why this rating - The materials emphasize a model-teacher identity, a living-curriculum approach, and a collegial, virtue-centered faculty culture, all of which align with CLASSICAL indicators. The presence of advanced degrees and named faculty leadership further supports the rating.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes parent partnership, seeing parents as co-teachers and participants in the educational formation of their children. - There are explicit references to parental formation, reading groups, seminars, and classical book clubs to educate parents about classical education. - The campus opens to families and invites visits, with emphasis on family engagement and participation in school life (parent involvement, campus life).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs, open campus, family liturgy alignment, parent involvement. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no customer-service framing; no minimal parent involvement signals).

Why this rating - The school foregrounds deep parental partnership and active parent formation, which aligns with Classical education norms in category 6. The evidence of parental involvement and open-campus culture supports CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL contexts)

Not applicable here, as Habersham School is assessed as CLASSICAL across all six categories. If one were seeking to push toward an even more explicit canonical Great Books emphasis, potential steps would include: - More explicit articulation of Great Books and the Great Conversation in standard curriculum language across grade levels (not only in occasional program pages). - A formal, published mapping of all grades to a common scholé/recitation framework (explicit memory work and copy-work in multiple subjects beyond Latin and classical languages). - Department-level articulation of a “Living Curriculum” aligned to the Portrait of a Graduate with public-facing rubrics.

However, these are not required given the present CLASSICAL alignment across all categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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